

ZoneAlarm and ZoneAlarm Pro. ZoneAlarm is free, while the Pro version is not. All the above-mentioned features are available with ZoneAlarm, while ZoneAlarm Pro has many more levels of protection, like advanced virus and spyware protection, blocking pop-up banners and ad windows, eliminate Web site tracking devices, and more. ZoneAlarm Pro is available on a free trial basis for 15 days.

6.8 WinRAR

WinRAR is the Windows version of the file compression software RAR. It can achieve compression ratios in the order of 15 per cent or even less of the original file sizes.

A double-click on the WinRAR icon brings up the main window. The icon is automatically set up on your Desktop during installation. Select the files that you need to archive and click on the Add icon at the top left-hand corner of your screen. WinRAR provides you with different archiving options like deleting files after archiving, creating self-extracting (SFX) archives, and solid archives. The solid archive box is selected by default as it is the recommended option. The solid archive option slows down the compression and extraction but provides a better compression ratio. The 'Compression method' is generally selected as 'Best'. It is the slowest but provides the highest compression.

Advanced options

'Background archiving' allows you to continue with your work as the archiving takes place.

'Wait if other WinRAR copies are active' would make better use of your system resources if you schedule your archive or extract operations in a queued manner.

'Recovery record' a larger recovery record provides recovery